In early 2016, I was surprised to find support for my views from an unexpected source. Dr. Hagai Tsoref is the director of the State Documents and Commemoration Department of the Israel State Archives and has edited a memorial volume for Golda Meir, Israel's prime minister during the war.[1] Tsoref's clear advantage lies in his access to the State Archives' documentation of the conduct of the Prime Minister's Office during the war, in particular the diaries of the bureau and the cabinet meetings. Tsoref also had access to the complete protocols of the Agranat Commission (prior to their publication). The majority of those who have dealt with the Yom Kippur War—historians, journalists, and other researchers—did not have access to even a portion of the wealth of primary sources to which Tsoref was exposed. I will mention once again that the Agranat Commission investigated only the first three days of the war. Therefore, even if someone had access to all of the commission's protocols, he or she would still not come close to the abundance and authenticity of the materials to which Tsoref had access, which covered the period from October 3 to October 31, 1973, the date that the cease-fire came into de facto effect and the beginning of the diplomatic struggle.

Dr. Tsoref divided his research into three periods of time:

1. October 3–6, 1973: The days preceding the outbreak of the war and the war's first few hours
2. October 10–14, 1973: The end of the holding action stage and the launching of the attack phase
3. October 18–31, 1973: The end of the war and the transition to diplomatic activity

The core of Tsoref's research deals with the interfaces between the head of the Mossad, Zvi Zamir, and the Israeli political and military leadership. He describes the dynamic that developed between the main players over time, from which it emerges that the Mossad director, whose status was relatively low on the eve of the outbreak of the war, became the intelligence adviser to the prime minister as of October 10.

Tsoref's first insight is, "Much is said about the role of the Mossad and its director in the period leading up to the war, and about Zamir's warning of the outbreak of war which he received from Ashraf Marwan on October